

Tuesday 10th October - EOI and Pitch preparation::

- Events

- 18th October:

- CV / EOI / Pitch submission deadline (team admin)
- CV submission deadline (all members to submit individually)

- 26th of October (09:00 - 12:20): pitch day

- Some projects may be on different days.

- 27th of October - project award:

- Contact the academic sponsor supervisor and sponsor ASAP after the project award.

- State of play

- bid for projects through EOIs and pitches - Industry sponsors and academic projects are there to help you

- Expressions of Interest (Eoi)

- All Eols (and pitches) and marked (12% of total)

- The average of all three results in the final Eoi mark.
- Do NOT game the system by writing bad Eols for projects you don't want.
- Better Eols / pitches have a higher chance of getting the 1st choice.

- The Eoi template on Moodle:

- Don't go above 750 words.

- Write a different EOI for every pitch - tailor them - do them in subteams

- Company staff will want to know:
 - Why do you think the project is important and worth solving.
 - Want you to show ambition and interest in the project.
 - Understand the project / product / the context / competitors
- Research the company that you are working with:
 - Know what their company does.
 - General background on the company.

- Context of the Pitch:

- Motivation (20%)
 - Interest in the project
 - Why do you want to work with this company.
 - Matching of team skills to projects.
 - Overview of relevant individual and group skills in context of the project.
 - Address essential / desirable skills in the tender.
 - Soft skills (project management, teamwork etc)
 - Provide evidence and experience.
- Understanding of the brief and context (20%)
- Preliminary analysis (30%)
 - What to consider:**
 - Understanding of the brief:
 - This wider context of the project.
 - Existing products / competitors.

- Analysis - What to consider - How to achieve this:

- Proposed initial approach and motivation.
- Discussion of applicable tools / libraries / methods
- Identification of challenges and issues.
- Suggest a preliminary design / approach / technologies / validation.
 - Suggest and compare approaches (methods / tools / libraries)
 - Identify technical challenges and avoid bias.
 - Cover all aspects of the project.

- Management (20%)

- What to consider:

- The project management approach
- Preliminary 'high level project plan and timescales.
- Identification of challenges / skill gaps / contingency plans.

- How to achieve this:

- 'Briefly explain' how you will manage the project.
 - This will be agile/scrum.
 - Sprints, retros, backlogs etc
 - What testing will you apply.
- What the key parts of the project - who will address them - potential risks/challenges.
 - Define contingency plans in place - paired programming and knowledge exchange.

- Style (10%)

- What to consider:

- Formatting.
- Language / grammar / spelling

- Pitch video:

- Up to 10 minute presentation (submit in .mp4)

- Potential Structure:

- Introduction / outline / welcome / role
- Understanding of the project & context
- Technical analysis / proposed approach & strengths.
- Reasons why they should choose you:
 - technical skills, soft skills, project management, communication, commercial awareness.
- Summary of key points.

- Prep:

- Choose a pitch video lead.
- rehearse before recording.
- Know the structure and who is talking when (look organised).
- Pitch at the right level for the audience.

- Prepare some slides (maximum 5-6)

- Avoid overloading them with content
- Use visual elements (diagrams)